

Date	30 June 2026	Maximum Marks	4 Marks
Team ID		Project Name	Strategic Product Placement Analysis System

PROBLEM-SOLUTION FIT CANVAS 2.0

1 Customer Segment(s)

Who is your customer?

- **Retail Merchandisers:** Corporate planners deciding macro-level store layouts.
- **Retail Data Analysts:** Tasked with finding ROI in physical shelf space.
- **Store Managers:** Executing local cross-merchandising displays in brick-and-mortar locations.

4 Emotions: Before/After

How do customers feel before and after?

- **Before:** Overwhelmed by raw data rows; frustrated by "guessing" placements; blind to physical traffic patterns.
- **After:** Confident in data-driven layouts; empowered by clear visualizations; in control of floor profitability.

9 Problem Root Cause

What is the real reason this problem exists?

- Physical retail environments inherently lack the granular, automated "click-tracking" analytics found in e-commerce.

2 Jobs-to-be-Done / Problems

Which jobs-to-be-done do you address?

- **Identify Hotspots:** Determine the optimal physical store locations to cross-merchandise premium products to maximize visibility.
- **Disrupt Autopilot:** Strategically place items to break shopper "autopilot" routing and increase spontaneous, high-margin impulse buys.
- **Data Synthesis:** Translate flat, overwhelming POS (Point of Sale) spreadsheet data into actionable 3D/2D spatial context.
- **Prove ROI:** Justify premium shelf-space negotiations with brand partners using concrete traffic metrics.

5 Available Solutions

What are the current alternatives?

- **Hardware Sensors/Cameras:** Highly accurate but require massive CapEx investment and cause privacy concerns.

10 Your Solution

How do you solve this within constraints?

- **Hardware-Free Spatial Engine:** A web platform that ingests standard 2D store floor plans (PDF/PNG) and historical POS CSV data.
- **AI Heatmapping:** Algorithms map sales density to physical aisles, generating an interactive spatial heatmap overlay.
- **Predictive Placements:** The system highlights underutilized "cold zones" adjacent to "hot zones" perfect for secondary cross-merchandising displays.
- **Exportable Strategy:** Generates PDF layout guides for store managers to implement physical display changes easily.

3 Triggers

What triggers customers to act?

- Introduction of a new, highly-prioritized premium product line requiring maximum physical visibility.

- Mentally mapping thousands of rows of 2D sales data into a physical 3D space is mathematically and cognitively impossible for humans at scale.

- **Third-party Consultants:** Provide point-in-time analysis but are extremely expensive and slow.
- **Trial & Error:** Moving displays manually and tracking sales over months (slow feedback loop, risks lost revenue).

- Declining physical store sales compared to the brand's e-commerce channels.
- Mandates from corporate to increase average basket size per shopper.

6 Customer Constraints

What prevents them from taking action?

- **Budget:** No capital approved for installing smart-cameras or IoT shelf sensors.
- **Technical Skill:** Store managers lack training to use complex, enterprise-grade spatial mapping software (e.g., AutoCAD).
- **Compliance:** Strict fire-safety and corporate brand rules limit where displays can physically be placed.

7 Behaviour

What do they currently do to address it?

- Manually export POS data into Excel and use Pivot Tables to guess which categories drive foot traffic.
- Physically walk the store floor with a clipboard, trying to observe and intuitively map shopper routing paths.

8 Channels of Behaviour

Where do they take action?

- **8.1 Online:** Researching retail tech on LinkedIn; attending webinars on omnichannel strategy; searching for "heatmap software without cameras."
- **8.2 Offline:** Attending physical retail trade shows (e.g., NRF Big Show); corporate strategy meetings; physical store audits.